

7d To rent or to buy?



Real life expressing preferences and giving reasons

- 1 Work in pairs. Write a checklist of things to bear in mind when you are looking for somewhere to live.
- 2 2.5 Listen to a conversation at an estate agent's. Does the woman mention the things on your checklist? What six things does she specify?
- 3 2.5 Look at the expressions for expressing preferences. Listen to the conversation again. Complete the expressions.

▶ EXPRESSING PREFERENCES

I think I'd rather _____ than _____, for now anyway.

I'd prefer _____, but not too _____.

So, two bedrooms, and preferably with _____.

Would you rather _____ places or _____ ones?

To be honest, I prefer _____ to _____.

I must say I prefer living _____.

I haven't got a car. I prefer to _____ or _____.

- 4 Work in pairs. Can you remember the reasons for the speakers' preferences? Compare your ideas. Then check in the audioscript on page 178.

5 Pronunciation rising and falling intonation

- a 2.6 Listen to this question. Notice how the intonation rises then falls.

Would you rather live in a town or a village?

- b 2.7 Listen and repeat these questions.

- 1 Do you prefer playing football or basketball?
- 2 Would you rather have tea or coffee?
- 3 Do you prefer summer or winter?
- 4 Would you rather go by car or by bike?
- 5 Do you prefer English or French?
- 6 Would you rather eat fish or meat?

- c Work in pairs. Add at least six more pairs of items to the pairs in Exercise 5b. Take turns to ask and answer about your preferences.

- 6 Work in groups of three. Where would you rather live? Ask and answer questions using these ideas. Explain your reasons. What do your choices say about the kind of person you are?

In a new house or in an old one?

In a city or in a village?

In a town centre or in the suburbs?

At the coast or in the mountains?

In a historic area or in a new development?